

PROJECT VERACITY

Team Onboarding & Collaboration Guide

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AI & Automation (Beyond Wrappers)

The Self-Healing Hallucination Firewall

COLOR LEGEND

YOU (Team Leader)

TEAMMATES (Members 2/3/4)

EVERYONE

SECTION 1 — WHAT YOU NEED TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

Two things keep your team in sync:

TOOL	WHAT IT SOLVES	WHO NEEDS IT
CONTEXT.md	Keeps Claude AI in sync across all 4 laptops. Paste it at the start of every Claude conversation so the AI knows your full project.	Everyone — before every Claude session
GitHub	Keeps actual CODE in sync across all 4 laptops. Prevents two people overwriting each other's work.	Everyone — before and after every coding session

SECTION 2 — WHAT YOU (TEAM LEADER) MUST DO FIRST

Do these steps ONCE before sharing anything with teammates.

STEP 1 Create the .gitignore file

YOU

In the ROOT of project-veracity/, create a file named .gitignore with the content below. This prevents .env, node_modules, and API keys from being uploaded to GitHub.

Create file: project-veracity/.gitignore

```
backend/.env/  
backend/vault_db/  
backend/__pycache__/  
backend/.env  
frontend/veracity-ui/node_modules/  
frontend/veracity-ui/.next/
```

STEP 2 Create a GitHub Repository

YOU

Go to github.com, sign in, click New Repository. Name it project-veracity. Set it to PRIVATE. Do NOT initialize with README (you already have files). Click Create Repository.

STEP 3 Push your code to GitHub

YOU

Run these commands in PowerShell from inside the project-veracity/ folder:

```
cd C:\Users\neelg\OneDrive\Desktop\project-veracity  
git init  
git add .  
git commit -m "initial project setup"  
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/project-veracity.git  
git branch -M main  
git push -u origin main
```

Replace YOUR_USERNAME with your actual GitHub username.

STEP 4 Add teammates to GitHub repo

YOU

Go to your GitHub repo > Settings > Collaborators > Add people. Enter each teammate's GitHub username or email. They will receive an invite by email. They must accept the invite before they can clone the repo.

STEP 5 Share these two things with every teammate

YOU

Send them this PDF file AND the GitHub repo link. That is all they need to get started.

SECTION 3 — WHAT EACH TEAMMATE MUST DO (ONCE)

Every new team member does these steps **ONCE** on their own laptop.

STEP 1 Accept the GitHub invitation

THEM

Check your email for an invite from GitHub. Click Accept Invitation. If you don't see it, ask the team leader to resend from repo Settings > Collaborators.

STEP 2 Install prerequisites

THEM

Make sure you have Python 3.10+ and Node.js 18+ installed. Check by running: `python --version` and `node --version` in PowerShell.

```
python --version
```

```
node --version
```

STEP 3 Clone the repository

THEM

This downloads the full project to your laptop:

```
git clone https://github.com/LEADER_USERNAME/project-veracity.git
```

```
cd project-veracity
```

STEP 4 Set up the Python backend

THEM

Create your own virtual environment (do not share `.venv` — each laptop needs its own):

```
cd backend
```

```
python -m venv .venv
```

```
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
```

```
# If blocked by policy, run this first:
```

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope CurrentUser
```

```
pip install fastapi uvicorn[standard] transformers torch chromadb sentence-transformers
```

```
pydantic python-dotenv httpx
```

STEP 5 Set up the frontend

THEM

Install Node dependencies (`node_modules` is not in GitHub — each laptop installs locally):

```
cd ../frontend/veracity-ui
```

```
npm install
```

STEP 6**Create your .env file****THEM**

This file is NOT on GitHub (it's in .gitignore for security). Create it manually inside the backend/ folder:

Create file: backend/.env

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-your-key-here
```

Ask the team leader for the actual API key value. Never share it publicly.

STEP 7**Load CONTEXT.md into Claude before every session****THEM**

Open CONTEXT.md (included with this PDF). Copy the entire contents. Open Claude (claude.ai). Paste as your FIRST message. Claude will now fully understand the project and give accurate help.

SECTION 4 — DAILY WORKFLOW FOR EVERYONE

Do this EVERY time you sit down to work on the project.

#	WHEN	ACTION	COMMAND / STEP
1	Session START	Activate virtual env	<code>.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1</code>
2	Session START	Pull latest code from GitHub	<code>git pull</code>
3	Before coding	Load CONTEXT.md into Claude	Copy CONTEXT.md → paste in new Claude chat
4	While coding	ONLY edit files assigned to you	See file ownership table in Section 5
5	Session END	Save your work to GitHub	<code>git add . → git commit -m "what you built" → git push</code>
6	Session END	Deactivate virtual env	<code>deactivate</code>

SECTION 5 — WHO BUILDS WHAT (NO CONFLICTS)

Each person owns specific files. Never edit someone else's file without telling them.

MEMBER	FILES OWNED	WHAT THEY BUILD
YOU (Team Leader)	<code>interceptor.py</code> <code>main.py</code>	SSE stream handler, claim boundary detector, FastAPI app entry, route wiring
Member 2	<code>sentinel.py</code> <code>rewriter.py</code>	HaluGate NLI classifier wrapper, REVERSE backtracking algorithm
Member 3	<code>models.py</code> <code>vault.py</code>	Pydantic schemas (Claim, Token, VerificationResult), ChromaDB vault operations
Member 4	<code>types/index.ts</code> <code>TokenStream.tsx</code> <code>app/page.tsx</code>	TypeScript interfaces, token display component, main UI with SSE consumer and green highlight

SECTION 6 — HOW TO USE CONTEXT.MD WITH CLAUDE

1

Open Claude

Go to claude.ai in your browser. Start a NEW conversation.

2

Paste CONTEXT.md

Open the CONTEXT.md file in any text editor (Notepad is fine). Select All (Ctrl+A). Copy (Ctrl+C). Paste it as your first message in Claude (Ctrl+V). Press Enter.

3

Wait for acknowledgment

Claude will confirm it understands the project. You'll see it describe Project Veracity, the tech stack, and your build status.

4

Now ask for help

You can now ask Claude to write code for your assigned files, debug errors, explain concepts, or review your code. Claude will give answers specific to this exact project.

5

Keep context alive

Claude loses memory when you close the tab. Every new conversation = paste CONTEXT.md again first.

PRO TIPS FOR ASKING CLAUDE

Be specific about your file: Say 'Help me write vault.py' not just 'Help me code'.

Mention your error exactly: Copy-paste the full error message from PowerShell into Claude.

Ask for explanations: If you don't understand a pattern, ask 'Explain how asyncio.gather works in interceptor.py'.

Request code that fits the project: Claude knows your exact file structure and will write imports correctly.

SECTION 7 — GIT QUICK REFERENCE

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE
<code>git pull</code>	Download latest code from GitHub	Always at session START
<code>git status</code>	See which files you changed	Anytime — check before committing
<code>git add .</code>	Stage all your changes	Before committing
<code>git commit -m "message"</code>	Save changes with a description	After finishing a feature/file
<code>git push</code>	Upload your commits to GitHub	Always at session END

<code>git log --oneline</code>	See recent commits history	To check what was done
<code>git diff</code>	See exactly what lines you changed	Before committing

■ IF YOU GET A MERGE CONFLICT

A merge conflict happens if two people edited the same file. To avoid this, ALWAYS follow the file ownership table in Section 5.

If it happens anyway: Run `git status` to see which files conflict. Open the conflicted file — look for lines with `<<<<<<<` and `>>>>>>>`. Keep the correct version, delete the markers, save the file. Then run `git add .` and `git commit -m 'resolved conflict'`. Or just call the team leader — don't guess.

SECTION 8 — CURRENT BUILD STATUS

FILE	STATUS	OWNER
Backend .venv	■ Done	You
Frontend Next.js init	■ Done	You
<code>models.py</code>	■ Build next	Member 3
<code>vault.py</code>	■ Not started	Member 3
<code>sentinel.py</code>	■ Not started	Member 2
<code>rewriter.py</code>	■ Not started	Member 2
<code>interceptor.py</code>	■ Not started	You
<code>main.py</code>	■ Not started	You
<code>types/index.ts</code>	■ Not started	Member 4
<code>TokenStream.tsx</code>	■ Not started	Member 4
<code>app/page.tsx</code>	■ Not started	Member 4